

WRITING MECHANICS FOR TOEFL WRITING

Comprehensive Reference Guide & Mechanics Handbook • Telegram: [TOEFL ZONE \(t.me/toeflzone\)](https://t.me/toeflzone)

1. Sentence Structures & Clauses

Compound Sentences with Coordinating Conjunctions (FANBOYS)

Conjunction	Example Sentences
but	I studied hard for the exam, but I still found it challenging.
so	She wanted to go for a walk, so she put on her shoes and left the house.
or	We can go to the beach, or we can visit the museum.
yet	The project was due on Friday, yet they finished it ahead of time.
and	He loves to read books, and he often spends his weekends at the library.

Compound Sentences with Conjunctive Adverbs

Conjunctive Adverb	Example Sentences
however	I studied for hours; however, I still did not pass the test.
therefore	She didn't feel well; therefore, she stayed home from work.
nevertheless	The weather was terrible; nevertheless, we decided to go hiking.
consequently	He was late to the meeting; consequently, he missed the presentation.
thus	The team played well; thus, they won the championship.

Complex Sentences with Adverb Clauses

- I will go to the gym **after** I finish my homework.
- She sang beautifully **even though** she was nervous.
- We stayed inside **because** it was raining.
- **Whenever** he travels, he takes a lot of photos.
- **As soon as** she arrives, we can start the meeting.

Complex Sentences with Noun Clauses

- I believe **that** she will succeed in her new job.
- The teacher asked **if** anyone had any questions.
- **What** he said was very insightful.
- She explained **why** she could not attend the event.
- They were curious about **what** would happen next.

Complex Sentences with Relative Clauses

- The book **that** you lent me was fascinating.
- She met a scientist **who** discovered a new species.
- The house, **which** is over a hundred years old, needs some repairs.
- The students **who** study hard often achieve great results.
- This is the place **where** we first met.

2. Advanced Grammatical Structures

Reduced Adverb & Adjective Clauses

Clause Type	Structure (Original → Reduced Form)
Reduced Adverb	While she was waiting for the bus → While waiting for the bus , she read a book.
Reduced Adverb	After he finished dinner → After finishing dinner , he went for a walk.
Reduced Adverb	Although she was tired → Although tired , she continued to work.
Reduced Adverb	Because he was feeling tired → Feeling tired , he went to bed early.
Reduced Adverb	When they saw the results → Seeing the results , they celebrated their success.
Reduced Adverb	Living in the city, I get to experience a lot of cultural events.
Reduced Adverb	After I had done my homework → Having done my homework , I decided to relax.
Reduced Adjective	The man who is standing by the door → The man standing by the door is my uncle.
Reduced Adjective	The woman who is wearing the red dress → The woman wearing the red dress is a famous actress.
Reduced Adjective	Books that are written by famous authors → Books written by famous authors often become bestsellers.

Clause Type	Structure (Original → Reduced Form)
Reduced Adjective	The car that is parked outside → The car parked outside belongs to my neighbor.
Reduced Adjective	The song that was played at the wedding → The song played at the wedding was beautiful.

Inversion

1. **Never have I seen** such a beautiful sunset.
2. **Rarely do we get** the opportunity to travel abroad.
3. **Not only did he finish** the project on time, **but he also** exceeded expectations.
4. **Seldom have I encountered** such kindness.
5. **Hardly had the meeting started** when the fire alarm went off.

Conditional Sentences

Zero Conditional (General truths or laws of nature)

- If it rains, the grass gets wet.
- If you touch a flame, you get burned.
- If you don't water plants, they die.

First Conditional (Real and possible scenarios and likely outcomes)

- If it rains tomorrow, we will cancel the picnic.
- If you study hard, you will pass the exam.
- If he works overtime, he will earn more money.

Second Conditional (Hypothetical or unreal situations in the present/future)

- If I were rich, I would travel the world.
- If he studied more, he would get better grades.
- If she knew the answer, she would tell us.

Third Conditional (Hypothetical past situations that did not happen)

- If I had known about the party, I would have gone.
- If he had studied harder, he would have passed the exam.
- If they had left earlier, they would have avoided traffic.
- If she had brought her umbrella, she wouldn't have gotten wet.

Mixed Conditionals (Combine elements of 2nd & 3rd conditionals)

- If he had studied harder, he would be more successful now. (*past event affecting present*)
- If she had gone to bed earlier, she wouldn't be tired now. (*past event affecting present*)
- If I were you, I would have handled the situation differently. (*present hypothetical affecting past*)
- If we had saved more money, we could be traveling now. (*past event affecting present*)
- If they were more experienced, they would have avoided the mistake. (*present hypothetical affecting past*)

Perfect Modal Verbs (Essential for Integrated Writing Tasks)

- He **must have missed** the bus.
- She **might have left** her keys at home.
- They **could have finished** the project earlier.
- He **may have forgotten** the appointment.
- She **must have been** very busy yesterday.
- They **might have taken** the wrong train.
- You **should have told** me about the problem.
- I **would have called** you, but I lost your number.

Indirect Speech

Direct Speech	Indirect Speech Conversion
She said, "I am going to the store."	She said that she was going to the store.
He said, "I have finished my homework."	He said that he had finished his homework.
They said, "We will come to the party."	They said that they would come to the party.
She said, "I can help you with your project."	She said that she could help me with my project.
He asked, "Do you like ice cream?"	He asked if I liked ice cream.

3. Verb Tenses Reference

Tense	Example Sentence (Verb: To Read)
Present Simple	He reads books in his free time.
Present Continuous	He is reading a book right now.
Present Perfect	He has read three books this month.
Present Perfect Continuous	He has been reading for two hours.
Past Simple	He read a book last night.
Past Continuous	He was reading a book when the phone rang.
Past Perfect	He had read the book before the exam.
Past Perfect Continuous	He had been reading for an hour when the phone rang.
Future Simple	He will read a book tomorrow.
Future Continuous	He will be reading a book at this time tomorrow.
Future Perfect	He will have read the book by the end of the week.
Future Perfect Continuous	He will have been reading for two hours by the time you arrive.

4. Stylistic Errors to Avoid

Parallel Structure

- She likes **reading, writing, and jogging**.
- The teacher asked the students **to write** their essays, **to submit** them online, and **to review** their feedback.
- In the meeting, we discussed **the budget, the timeline, and the deliverables**.
- The company values **honesty, integrity, and dedication**.
- To succeed in life, you need to be **patient, persistent and positive**.
- She wants to travel to Europe **to learn** new languages and **(to) experience** different cultures.
- The car was **old, rusty, and unreliable**.
- He is not only a **talented musician** but also a **skilled painter** and an **excellent writer**.

Sentence Fragments

Fragment Style	Corrected Version
Fragment Because I was late.	Correction Because I was late, I missed the beginning of the meeting.
Fragment Although he was tired.	Correction Although he was tired, he stayed up late to finish his work.
Fragment If they had more time.	Correction If they had more time, they would have completed the task.

Run-On Sentences & Comma Splices

Problematic Sentence	Proper Corrections
Run-On I went to the store I forgot to buy milk.	• I went to the store, but I forgot to buy milk. • I went to the store; I forgot to buy milk.
Run-On She loves to read she finishes a book every week.	• She loves to read; she finishes a book every week.
Run-On It's raining heavily I don't want to go out.	• It's raining heavily, so I don't want to go out.
Run-On He is very talented he plays the piano beautifully.	• He is very talented; he plays the piano beautifully.
Comma Splice I went to the store, I forgot to buy milk.	• I went to the store, but I forgot to buy milk. • I went to the store; I forgot to buy milk. • I went to the store. I forgot to buy milk.
Comma Splice She loves to read, she finishes a book every week.	• She loves to read, and she finishes a book every week. • She loves to read; she finishes a book every week. • She loves to read. She finishes a book every week.
Comma Splice It's raining heavily, I do not want to go out.	• It's raining heavily, so I do not want to go out. • It's raining heavily; I do not want to go out. • It's raining heavily. I do not want to go out.

Choppy Sentences

Choppy Form	Improved Style
She went to the store. She bought some milk. She came back home.	She went to the store, bought some milk, and came back home.

Choppy Form	Improved Style
I like to read. I like to write. I like to draw.	I like to read, write, and draw.
He is tired. He wants to sleep. He has a headache.	He is tired, wants to sleep, and has a headache.

Stringy Sentences

Stringy Form	Improved Style
She went to the store and she bought some groceries and then she went home and cooked dinner and watched TV.	She went to the store, bought some groceries, and then went home to cook dinner before watching TV.
He woke up early and he had breakfast and he went to the gym and he worked out for an hour and then he went to work.	He woke up early, had breakfast, went to the gym for an hour, and then headed to work.
They planned a trip and they packed their bags and they left for the airport and they checked in their luggage and boarded the plane.	They planned a trip, packed their bags, left for the airport, checked in their luggage, and boarded the plane.